

Curator Choice Gallery Student Handout

TOK Cognitive Science Activity Bank • The Arts • 30-40 min

Category	The Arts	Time	30-40 min
Difficulty	Medium	ID	curator-choice-gallery

Big idea: Curators do not only display knowledge in the arts; they help organize and produce it.

Student-Facing Prompt

Inspect Curator Choice Gallery Stimulus A. Record one first claim, the evidence you used, your confidence, and what would make you revise.

Concrete Stimulus Packet

Curator Choice Gallery Stimulus A	Student-facing stimulus 1: Artwork set: empty chair, crowded street, broken cup, bright abstract pattern, family photo, dark landscape. Describe what you see or hear first, then add title/context and revise the interpretation.	Students inspect this exact card first and commit to a claim before hearing anyone else.
Curator Choice Gallery Stimulus B	Student-facing stimulus 2: Curatorial themes: loss, modern life, beauty in ordinary objects, uncertainty, memory. Describe what you see or hear first, then add title/context and revise the interpretation.	Use this for comparison, a second round, or a partner challenge.
Curator Choice Gallery Reveal / Twist	Student-facing stimulus 3: Curatorial themes: loss, modern life, beauty in ordinary objects, uncertainty, memory. Describe what you see or hear first, then add title/context and revise the interpretation.	Teacher reveal: connect the changed response to the big idea — Curators do not only display knowledge in the arts; they help organize and produce it.

Actual Lesson Questions

#	Question for students
1	After inspecting Curator Choice Gallery Stimulus A, what is your first knowledge claim?
2	Which exact detail from Curator Choice Gallery Stimulus A did you use as evidence?
3	What did you infer beyond the evidence?
4	How confident are you: 50%, 60%, 70%, 80%, 90%, or 100%?
5	What missing information would most improve the knowledge claim?
6	How do institutions shape knowledge in the arts?

Ready-to-Use Examples

- Artwork set: empty chair, crowded street, broken cup, bright abstract pattern, family photo, dark landscape.
- Curatorial themes: loss, modern life, beauty in ordinary objects, uncertainty, memory.

Student Task

Use the stimulus cards to complete the observation/inference/evidence/confidence grid, then answer one TOK knowledge question connected to The Arts.

Activity Steps

1. Give groups the same artwork cards and a different curatorial theme.
2. Groups arrange the works in a sequence and write a title for the gallery.
3. Students add two wall labels explaining key choices.
4. Groups tour each gallery and record how the sequence changed meaning.
5. Debrief curation as interpretation, argument, and knowledge production.

Observation and Evidence Record

Use this grid to keep observation, inference, evidence, and confidence separate.

What I noticed	What I inferred	Evidence	Confidence

TOK Debrief

- Knowledge question: How do institutions shape knowledge in the arts?
- Can arrangement change what an artwork means?
- What responsibility does a curator have to viewers and artists?

Knowledge Questions

- How do institutions shape knowledge in the arts?
- Can selection and sequence create meaning?
- What counts as evidence for a curatorial interpretation?

Transfer Example

For example, run this activity with groups curate the same artworks under themes such as rebellion, beauty, identity, or power. Have students commit to an initial claim, then reveal the change, hidden rule, alternative context, or comparison that makes the knowledge problem visible.

Exit Ticket

- One thing I first treated as evidence was...
- My confidence changed because...
- A better knowledge question I can now ask is...